

new things. These days, technology isn't just a luxury. Many items are functional and helpful, and don't have to be expensive.

6. Become an expert in something.

If you don't already have an expertise, get one. Having a hobby and devoting yourself to an interest can distract you from the marketing messages pushing your consumer buttons.

7. Forgive yourself for frugal lapses.

Stay upbeat even when you take a frugal misstep or just feel like paying for convenience. You may not lead in every stretch of the race but you'll be a winner of the marathon.

8. Be nice to the wealthy.

There are people who can reside in 3,000+-square-foot homes, drive up-

scale cars, take luxury vacations, *and* give to charity, build wealth, and enjoy honorable lives. They have much in common with the frugal: They want to be admired for *who they are* rather than their net worth. Make friends and don't worry about spending differences.

Frugality is more than saving a few pennies and becoming debt-free. It's about pursuing your dreams and not letting someone else define your success. — **Julie Rains**

